

5.10 Miscellaneous Tools

The tools mentioned here add additional layers of security to your system.

5.10.1 Anonymisers

5.10.1.1 Introduction

“Anonymous Browsing” is an oxymoron. Any system on the Net is uniquely identified; this is a prerequisite, since otherwise there cannot be corruption-free data transfer. Without the destination address properly identified, data packets cannot reach the intended system, period.

What a person who is paranoid about privacy can do is ensure that the data path between the source and destination is not direct. A direct path makes the process of identification easy, as easy as a whois lookup (at ip-address.domaintools.com, for instance). By taking a circuitous route, and encrypting the data in transit, the person can achieve a level of privacy that can be invaded only by employing significant resources (it can still be done). It needs to be pointed out that even the “direct” path involves different routers that form the backbone of the Internet. Run a “tracert xyz.abc.com” command at a command prompt to find the number of nodes that route the traffic between you and xyz.abc.com.

5.10.1.2 TOR (The Onion Router)

This application channels data through a circuitous route. The TOR network consists of a network of volunteers who share their systems and bandwidths for channelling data from the source to the destination of any user connected to it. The core TOR application encrypts data at the source, and sends the data packets through a path that passes through many intermediate nodes, with each node reworking the data packet. The number of nodes is usually three. The data packet, as it leaves the source, only has the destination address of the first node in the path. After the packet reaches the first node, its destination address is